The latter—known as Containers as a Service (CaaS) platforms—are the closest thing to Heroku in a containerized world. They let you focus on your app and worry less about the infrastructure it runs on. For many, this is a popular option to get started. It's fast to get something up and running, and you offload a lot of the responsibilities, including many security considerations, to the platform. However, this comes at the price of less flexibility and customization—you're limited by the capabilities exposed by the platform.

The choice is not as discrete as it sounds. Even across different CaaS platforms, you'll find that more or less work is done for you.

Next, we'll look at some options around tools for provisioning IaaS infrastructure, were you to go down that route, before taking a brief tour of the big players in the CaaS space.

Provisioning Your Infrastructure

If you go down the IaaS route, in theory you can go with any cloud provider; they are just providing the raw infrastructure that you'll run your Docker containers on top of.

Here are some of the big players that you've probably heard of:

- Amazon AWS[6]
- Microsoft Azure[7]
- Google Compute Engine (GCE)[8]
- DigitalOcean[9]

However, you're going to need to provision your infrastructure, and in particular, the instances that Docker and your orchestration layer will be installed on. There are a number of tools that can assist you in this endeavor.

Docker Machine

Docker Machine[10] is a standalone tool for provisioning and managing Docker-ready instances. It not only creates an instance, but it installs Docker on the instance at the same time. This makes Docker Machine a really lightweight, friendly tool to get started with.

6. https://aws.amazon.com
7. https://azure.microsoft.com
8. https://cloud.google.com/compute/
9. https://www.digitalocean.com
10. https://docs.docker.com/machine/overview/